

Nick Heindl

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Madison, WI, USA

Tech Designer and Accessibility Champion

Resourceful Tech Designer with 10 years of AAA gameplay XP across engineering and design. Nick has an infectious passion for game accessibility, learning new technologies and techniques, collaborating with different roles, and empowering teams to do their best work. “Force Multiplier”, “Mentor”, and “Advocate” are all terms used by previous leads to describe Nick and his impact.

Selected Work History

ZeniMax Online Studios (Xbox, Bethesda)

Unannounced AAA MMORPG

Principal Accessibility Technical Designer
Senior Technical Designer

July 2023 – July 2025
August 2021 – July 2023

PUBG Corporation

PlayerUnknown's Battlegrounds (PUBG)

Software Engineer

October 2020 – July 2021

Raven Software (Activision Blizzard)

*Call of Duty: Warzone, Call of Duty: Modern Warfare, Call of Duty: Cold War,
Call of Duty: Black Ops 4, Call of Duty: Online (China)*

Gameplay Engineer
Associate Gameplay Engineer
Gameplay Engineer Intern

May 2016 – October 2020
May 2016 – February 2018
Summer 2015

Leadership and Collaboration

ZeniMax Online Studios

- Founded and Led Accessibility Team
- Product Owner responsible for Accessibility across project
- Created script review process, best practices, and tool workflows for users across disciplines
- Onboarded and trained multiple tech designers; Mentored many designers across departments
- Collaborated closely with stakeholders to create multi-year product roadmaps and strategies
- Contributed to Xbox-wide talks and initiatives related to Design, Accessibility, and Publishing
- Triage and prioritized bugs and workflow issues with stakeholders to maximize dev efficiency
- Consistently relied upon to jump into new areas to diagnose, triage, and firefight problems

PUBG Corporation

- Brought on to help kickstart a new engineering team at a young studio
- Assisted Tech Director with setting up a recruiting and interviewing process
- Consulted with internal/external departments to enact a new Perforce workflow

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Leadership and Collaboration (Continued)

Raven Software

- Led small, multidisciplinary team in Activision-wide innovation competition
- Sole team to pitch to executives twice: 2018 Business Pitch, 2019 Creative Pitch
- Collaborated with worldwide teams to set up analytics design & instrumentation
- Engineering mentor to interns and folks in many departments (Eng./Design/QA)
- Travelled with the University Relations team to recruit at schools across the US

Personal

- Actively coaching and mentoring students and presenting talks and panels to conferences
- Certified Accessible Player Experience Practitioner (CAPXP): accessible.games/apxp

Technical Proficiency

ZeniMax Online Studios | New proprietary ECS-based engine, AngelScript, C++, C#

- Technical Product Owner of Narrative Systems from first implementation through prototype
- Worked closely with engineering to help guide direction of custom visual script environment
- Wrote utility libraries, exemplar content, feature MVPs, and tests for visual script environment
- Prototyped various features, including first example of RPG choice & consequence
- Worked closely with 3Cs team to balance movement and camera to minimize Sim Sickness
- Partnered with Combat team to revamp Aim Assist systems and give designers live-edit tooling
- Led effort to assess, prototype, and scale up various systems by architecting a Murder Mystery
- Performed technical evaluations and breakdowns of third-party software

PUBG Corporation | Unreal Engine 4, C++, PowerShell

- Engineering feature owner for new vehicles as part of an unreleased map
- Bolstered the new remote workflow with git and p4 to support non-technical staff
- Polished new game mode variant for ship

Raven Software | 3+ proprietary engines, C++, Custom Script Language (GSC), Lua

- Led small team to design, architect, and implement Warzone's Ping Marker system
- Made new modes (Survival Plus, BR, etc.) and ported modes (Hardpoint, KC, etc.)
- Engineering owner for player mechanics & movement on unreleased CoD project
- Built an automated testing tool to assist Design and QA on CoD's first Battle Royale
- Created enemy AI (Crab) and treasure goblin system (Monkey) for Zombie mode
- Designed & built player ranking system; Used live metrics to tune rewards
- Refactored and optimized live, heavily used MP systems (Equipment, etc.)
- Profiled code and established standards to reduce live service errors by tenfold

Personal | Love2D, Unity3D, Godot, Ink, Twine, Lua, JavaScript, Go, etc.

- Typing game with dynamic phrase generation; Featured at GDC (team size 2)
- Contracted with Flippfly to port a prototype of indie title Race The Sun to AppleTV

Education

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Computer Sciences and Linguistics